Adolfo Andrés Hincapié García

Nationality: Colombia
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Profile

Interdisciplinary Forestry Engineer & Anthropologist (MSc Environmental Modeling) specialising in carbon compliance, monitoring & evaluation, and community engagement for complex carbon projects (REDD+, ARR, IFM, Agroforestry, ANR). Over 8 years of international experience combining deep technical expertise in geospatial tools and carbon methodologies with social-science grounding to optimise benefit-sharing, FPIC processes, and equitable mitigation strategies across Latin America, Africa, and Southeast Asia.

Adaptable, multilingual (Spanish, English, Portuguese), and committed to designing high-integrity climate interventions that generate social, environmental, and financial co-benefits.

The journey in the carbon market began in 2017 at South Pole as a Geospatial Analyst, where I supported and later led the development of nature-based solutions (NbS) in Latin America. I coordinated AFOLU projects across multiple countries, contributing to feasibility assessments, GHG estimations, spatial analysis, and the design of Theory of Change (ToC) frameworks.

Currently, I offer technical and strategic advisory services to multiple organizations on a freelance basis, providing hourly support for carbon certification, project validation, and MRV alignment.

Website: https://aahincapie.github.io/about_ess/
LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/aahincapie

ADOLFO ANDRES HINCAPIE

Monitoring & Evaluation Specialist | Safeguard & Community

Education

Federal University of Minas Gerais
Belo Horizonte, Brazil
2017

M.Sc.
Analysis and Modeling of Environmental Systems, Brazil, Belo Horizonte.
Scholarship: Coordenação de Aperfeiçoamento de Pessoal Alto Nivel (CAPES).

University of Antioquia
Medellín, Colombia
2013

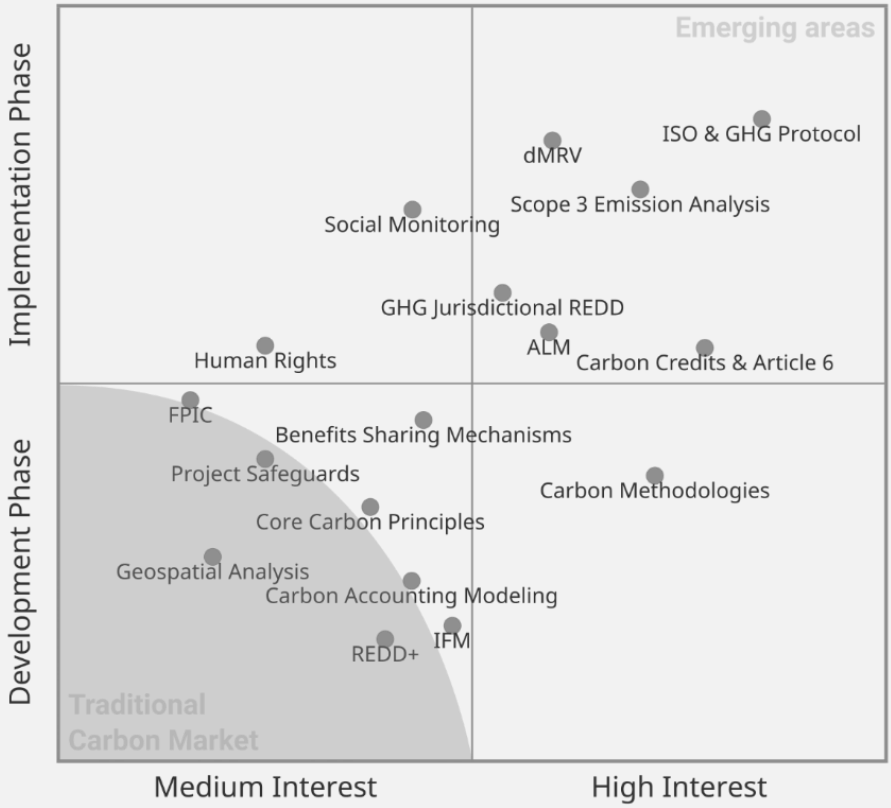
B.Sc.
Anthropology, Colombia, Medellín.

National University of Colombia
Medellín, Colombia
2012

B.Eng
Forest Engineering, Colombia, Medellín.

Main skills and interest

The chart maps key areas for business growth contributions, ranging from usual carbon credit mechanisms to emerging opportunities



Work experience

Freelance Consultant, Multiple Employers – Remote (Oct 2024 – Present)

- Provide technical and strategic advice to carbon project developers ensuring safeguard compliance with VCS, CCB, Gold Standard, Social Carbon, and VCI — with a focus on M&E implementation, safeguard information systems (SIS), and community engagement.
- Key mandates: Treevaluation — M&E design for supply-shed carbon feasibility study in a coffee sourcing region in Colombia (agroforestry/NCS scope); Klymera (co-founder) — GIS technical expertise in project implementation, biodiversity safeguards, and standard compliance; Carbon Credit Consulting (CCC) — Climate M&E ; Forliance, Xilva, Verra — project document review, compliance reviews, and integrity due diligence for REDD+ and ARR projects

Carbon Compliance Expert, Earthshot Lab, Remote (Oct 2023 – Oct 2024)

- Advised carbon project developers on safeguard compliance, Theory of Change (ToC) design, and FPIC decision-making frameworks for project implementation (REDD+, IFM, ARR).
- Advise projects and clients to ensure compliance with carbon standards and regulations (including ART/TREES, VCS, GS, Social Carbon, or Scope 3). Contribute to Earthshot Lab's mission to protect natural ecosystems and combat climate change by supporting the technical and scientific team and providing inputs for Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation (REDD), Improved Forest Management (IFM), and Afforestation Reforestation (ARR) initiatives into a machine learning technology to analyze carbon projects (LandOS platform).

Regional Lead NBS, Climate Projects, South Pole, Colombia (Jan 2023 – Oct 2023)

- Led the implementation and management of emission reduction projects, including drafting feasibility studies, project design documents (PDDs), monitoring reports (MRs), and providing technical and business development support. Led knowledge management and stayed up to date on the latest rule changes. Led community revalidation process of Chyulu Hills REDD+, supporting climate and JNR requirements for climate project.
- Provided technical reviews and business development support across the NBS portfolio.

Senior Project Coordinator – AFOLU, South Pole, Colombia (Jan 2021 - Dec 2022)

- Led the implementation and management of emission reduction projects, including leading and drafting feasibility studies and project design documents (PDDs), validation, monitoring, reporting, and verification (MRV) support under different standards (T-VER, CDM, VERRA, GS4GG).
- Designed and reviewed safeguard information systems (SIS), stakeholder engagement plans, grievance procedures, and benefit-sharing models for CCB projects across Latin America, Africa, and Southeast Asia.
- Supported gender-responsive planning and FPIC-aligned consultation processes with Indigenous and local communities in multiple project countries.

Project manager | Forestry & Land Use Projects, South Pole, Colombia (Jun 2019 – Dec 2020)

- Provided support for developing REDD and ARR projects related to GIS, forestry, and community issues. Supported the selection of projects, following up with stakeholders, and conducting due diligence on Brazilian projects.
- Developed operational inputs for local site visits and consultations with local stakeholders. Assisted with the development of project proposals.

GIS | Forestry & Land Use Projects, South Pole, Colombia (Jun 2017 – Jun 2019)

- Processed satellite and other remote sensing images to generate land cover maps for Peru (AIDER-Minagri). Provided technical support for the development of REDD and ARR projects. Developed a GIS and methodological construction of primary conditions for a jurisdictional approach based on carbon for Caquetá, Colombia. Developed a spatially explicit modeling and baseline evaluation for a jurisdictional approach on Isangi, Democratic Republic of Congo.

Environmental Analyst, WWF-OIA, Colombia (May 2016 - Dec 2016)

- Implemented participatory agreements, concepts, and strategies for the management of indigenous territories by developing spatial and GIS methodological designs with a participatory approach.
- Led inter-ethnic actions for defending indigenous territories and legal actions for the rights of Mother Earth against illegal mining in indigenous territories. Interacted and dialogued with governmental institutions and other stakeholders.

Consultancy, Universidad Nacional de Colombia, Colombia, Colombia (May 2016 - Jul 2016)

- Methodological designs for forest degradation in Colombia based on timber products. Interviews with timber stakeholders and focus groups of the forestry sector. Compilation of information on forest harvesting and timber products associated with forest degradation in Colombia. (Contract 2302831 of 2016 between FAO and the UN to ONUREDD)

Assistant professor, Universidade Federal de Minas Gerais, Brazil (Jul 2015 - Dic 2015)

- Tutoring the learning process to Environmental Engineer. Apply the assessments and others. Topics: History of cartography, Conceptual frameworks, Thematic Cartography and principles of remote sensing applied to monitoring the Earth.

Land Tenure and Land Use Advisor, Indigenous Organization of Antioquia, Colombia (Jul 2013 - Feb 2015)

- Incorporating spatial criteria of environmental regulation (risk, potential, and planning) into five indigenous livelihood plans of indigenous territories. Supporting activities in land tenure, land use, and projects of payments for environmental services and right to free, prior, and informed consent.

Forestry and Anthropologist (Consultancy), Renovatio Group Ltda, Colombia (Sep 2013 - May 2014)

- Developing the characterization of the area of influence in wind farm project, physical and biotic components. Environmental, Social and Corporate Governances (ESG) performance Asses. Geodatabase managing and others.

- Supporting social-environmental operations on wind farm project license
- Guiding environmental licenses and government permits regarding to free prior and informed consent

Anthropologist, Community Global Partership CGP.s.a.s, Colombia (Sep 2012 - Feb 2013)

- Developing a methodological approach to local stakeholders' consultation for the REDD+ project Guainía; Mapping and characterization of agents of deforestation, direct causes and underlying, and perspectives of evolution in the indigenous land of the department of Guainía.

Countries of Work Experience

- Argentina
- Colombia
- Brazil
- Peru
- Guatemala
- Democratic Republic of Congo
- Congo
- Ghana
- Ivory Coast
- Kenya
- Indonesia
- Cambodia
- New Zealand

Key experience by region

Region / Country	Year(s)	Project & Client	Safeguard & M&E Roles
Africa			
Kenya	2026	Biodiversity Credits in Partakilat Wild Conservancy	Assessment of Environmental and Social Risks & Impacts for Safeguard Conformance and Engagement
Ghana / Ivory Coast	2024	Scope 3 Assessment (Lindt & Sprüngli)	GHG Protocol Corporate Value Chain (Scope 3) — supply chain assessment for cocoa sourcing
DRC	2020	Isangi REDD+ (Safboi)	JNR nesting; Verra Jurisdictional REDD+ Framework v1 development
Kenya	2023	Chyulu Hills REDD+ (Maasai Wilderness)	Baseline reassessment CCB/VCS; community revalidation with Indigenous Maasai; grievance & safeguard review

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Region / Country	Year(s)	Project & Client	Safeguard & M&E Roles
Republic of Congo	2023	Ngabe REDD+ (Aither)	Leakage & safeguard alignment; Gold Standard safeguard requirements
Kenya	2018	Lake Naivasha (JB Travel AB)	PDD collaboration
Oceania - Southeast Asia			
Indonesia	2023–24	Flores REDD+/ARR (BirdLife International)	Feasibility — financial, institutional & technical; safeguard & FPIC assessment; field eligibility
Cambodia	2023	Lomphat Wildlife Sanctuary (BirdLife International)	VCS & CCB validation support; culturally adapted grievance pathways
New Zeland	2025	ARR Eligibility	NA
Latin America			
Argentina	2025-2026	Selva Urundel REDD+	Climate Monitoring Protocol and Compliance with VCS
Colombia	2012–13	Guainía REDD+ (Community Global Partnership)	Stakeholder consultation methodology; deforestation agent mapping for Indigenous territories
Colombia	2019	Sierra Nevada REDD+/ARR (TNC)	Project eligibility; feasibility; AFOLU activities (ARR/REDD)
Colombia	2020	Morrosquillo Blue Carbon (INVEMAR/CI)	VCS & CCB validation support documentation
Colombia	2024–25	Coffee Supply Shed Feasibility (Treevaluation)	M&E design for supply-shed carbon feasibility in coffee sourcing region
Brazil	2019	Serra do Amolar REDD+ (Instituto Homem Pantaneiro)	VCS & CCB initial validation; MRV support; VCU issuance
Brazil / Peru	2018	ISA Jaguar Fund (Interconexión Eléctrica S.A.)	AFOLU project eligibility & feasibility
Guatemala	2025	VCS CCB Reddes Locales para el Desarrollo	Assessment of Environmental and Social Risks & Impacts for Safeguard Conformance and Engagement

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION – ADOLFO ANDRES HINCAPIE

Personal references

Abel Marcarini: Abel is a carbon project lead for Brazil at Earthshot Labs. He has more than 10 years working on Nature Based Solutions for the voluntary carbon market and academic background in forestry. Before Earthshot Lab, Abel worked for Verra for two years and for South Pole for seven years.

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Phone: +55 21 98390-3179

Beatriz Zapata: Betty is a forest engineer with vast experience in carbon forest project initiatives. She has deep technical knowledge of methodologies, tools, and guidelines of the main standards used in the AFOLU sector, such as VCS, CCBS and Gold Standard. Beatriz has been working for South Pole for more than seven years.

Email: b.zapata@southpole.com
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Milena Agudelo: Milena is a manager for Nature Climate Solutions at Verra, responsible for reviewing registration and verification requests ensuring quality and integrity of ALM and WRC projects. She helps develop updates to existing rules and procedures and provides technical input for the development of new methodologies. Milena holds a bachelor's degree in Forest Engineering and a MSc in Forestry and Environmental Conservation. Previously, she supported Climate Friendly and South Pole for six years.

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Phone: +57 310 5470215

David Montoya González: David hold eight years of extensive experience in Remote Sensing and GIS. He leads the Remote Sensing and GIS team in TerraGlobal, using innovative software and tools that meet carbon market and impact standards and support community-based geospatial community monitoring. David worked for The National Department of Statistics (DANE) and South Pole for two years.

Email: gonzalez@terraglobalcapital.com
Phone: +57 300 4529610

Other mentors

Britaldo Soares-Filho	Google Scholar
Sonia Maria Carvalho	Google Scholar
Dolors Almenteras	Google Scholar